Persist Week of September 14, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com. We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, September 14th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 15th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 16th, 2026
- Thursday, September 17th, 2026
- Friday, September 18th, 2026
- Saturday, September 19th, 2026
- Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, September 14th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 15th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 16th, 2026
- Thursday, September 17th, 2026
- Friday, September 18th, 2026
- Saturday, September 19th, 2026
- Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, September 14th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 15th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 16th, 2026
- Thursday, September 17th, 2026
- Friday, September 18th, 2026
- Saturday, September 19th, 2026

- Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Pump Condition 5x
- Monday, September 14th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 15th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 16th, 2026
- Thursday, September 17th, 2026
- Friday, September 18th, 2026
- Saturday, September 19th, 2026
- Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Pump Condition 4x
- Monday, September 14th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 15th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 16th, 2026
- Thursday, September 17th, 2026
- Friday, September 18th, 2026
- Saturday, September 19th, 2026
- Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Pump Condition 3x
- Monday, September 14th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 15th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 16th, 2026
- Thursday, September 17th, 2026
- Friday, September 18th, 2026
- Saturday, September 19th, 2026
- Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Perform
- Monday, September 14th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 15th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 16th, 2026
- Thursday, September 17th, 2026
- Friday, September 18th, 2026
- Saturday, September 19th, 2026
- Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Minimalist
- Monday, September 14th, 2026
- Tuesday, September 15th, 2026
- Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

[Thursday, September 17th, 2026]
[Friday, September 18th, 2026]
[Saturday, September 19th, 2026]
[Sunday, September 20th, 2026]

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, September 14th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Shrug + Single Arm Farmer's Walk
Two trap-focused movements back to back. The DB shrug builds peak trap contraction at the top of the rep. Hold briefly before lowering. The single arm farmer's walk that follows demands the trap and shoulders to work isometrically to keep the loaded side from dropping while you walk. That anti-lateral flexion demand is a completely different stimulus than the shrug and hits the trap through time under tension rather than reps.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
2. DB Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Head Support Bent Over DB Row; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Rear Delt Swings; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90sec
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. DB Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Single Arm Farmer's Walk; 50ft/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, September 15th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Preacher Curl + Cable Tricep Pushdown

Two arm isolation movements are paired together to finish the session with a bicep and tricep pump. The preacher curl locks the upper arm against the pad, removing any swing and placing the entire load on the biceps during the bottom stretch. The cable tricep pushdown keeps constant tension through the full range. Push close to failure on each set with minimal rest between movements.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Seated Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
2. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
3. Supinated DB Front Raise; 10-12 @30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

1. Barbell Preacher Curl; 12 reps @21X1 Tempo

rest 45 sec

2. Cable Tricep Pushdown or Inverted Skullcrusher; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 45 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Hanging Knee Tuck

50 total reps of the hanging knee tuck in as few sets as possible. The hanging position requires grip and shoulder stability, while the core does the work. Break the reps however needed, but keep rest short between sets. The goal is to accumulate all 50 with quality. Hips should flex fully on each rep, and the legs should lower with control rather than dropping.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
2. Worlds Greatest Stretch; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Back Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Dumbbell Front Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Poliquin Step; 10-15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Elevated Side Plank Hip Taps; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Knee Tuck or Tuck Up; Perform 50 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select the exercise variation that will challenge you but feels attainable.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, September 17th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 5
4 Sets
- Side Plank Rotations x 10/side
- 30sec Extended Wall Plank
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 5
4 Sets
- 30sec Reverse Plank Bridge
- 15sec Clamshell Plank R
- 15sec Clamshell Plank L
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 5

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulders
Shoulder Circles x 5/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Friday, September 18th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Cross Body Hammer Curl + DB Skullcrusher
Two arm isolation movements paired to finish the session with a bicep and tricep pump. The cross body hammer curl pulls the dumbbell across the body, which emphasizes the brachialis and brachioradialis alongside the bicep. The dumbbell skullcrusher loads the triceps at the stretched position overhead. Push close to failure on each set with minimal rest between movements.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps
3. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
4. Plank Walk Up; 10 reps (5/side)

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Single Arm DB Row
Every 2:30 x 3 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Farmers Press; 7 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean In DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets

1. Dumbbell Cross Body Hammer Curl; 12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, September 19th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Single Arm Plank + Suitcase Single Leg Standing Calf Raise
Two movements that build stability and lower leg strength to finish the session. The single arm plank removes one point of contact, which demands that the core and shoulder resist lateral rotation. The suitcase single leg calf raise adds a unilateral demand to the calf and requires ankle stability through the full range. Keep the rep tempo slow on the calf raise — three seconds down keeps the calf under tension through the lowering phase.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Suitcase Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Split Stance DB Cross Body RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Arm Plank; 15-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
2. Suitcase Single Leg Standing Calf Raise; 8-10 reps/side @31X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Recovery Myth: Rest days set you back

This one might be my favorite myth to bust because I used to believe it myself. Early in my training, I thought every day off was a day I lost ground. What I didn't understand yet was that the adaptation, the actual strength and muscle building, happens during recovery, not during the workout itself. Training breaks your body down. Rest is when it rebuilds stronger. Skipping recovery to chase more work usually just leads to burnout, nagging injuries, and performance that stalls out or declines. Your rest days aren't time off from progress. They're part of the process. Trust them.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, September 14th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Shrug + Single Arm Farmer's Walk
Shrugs lift your shoulders straight up to work your traps. Squeeze hard at the top before you lower. The farmer's walk that follows makes those same muscles hold the weight steady while you walk and make sure you keep the shoulders back. You will definitely feel the traps worked after this superset.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Seated Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
2. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
3. Supinated DB Front Raise; 10-12 @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. DB Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Single Arm Farmer's Walk; 50ft/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Tuesday, September 15th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Hanging Knee Tuck
50 total reps of the hanging knee tuck in as few sets as possible. The hanging position requires grip and shoulder stability, while the core is doing the work. Break the reps however needed, but keep rest short between sets. The goal is to accumulate all 50 with quality. Hips should flex fully on each rep, and the legs should lower with control rather than dropping.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
2. Worlds Greatest Stretch; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Dumbbell Front Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Poliquin Step; 10-15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Elevated Side Plank Hip Taps; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

Hanging Knee Tuck or Tuck Up; Perform 50 reps in as few sets as possible.

Loading Note:

Select the exercise variation that is going to challenge you, but feels attainable.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work:

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Shoulders

Shoulder Circles x 5/side

Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min

Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps

Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Prayer Stretch x 2 min

Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold

Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side

Passive Hang x 1 min

Thursday, September 17th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Cross Body Hammer Curl + DB Skullcrusher
Two arm isolation movements paired to finish the session with a bicep and tricep pump. The crossbody hammer curl pulls the dumbbell across the body, emphasizing the brachialis and brachioradialis alongside the biceps. The dumbbell skullcrusher loads the tricep at the stretched position overhead. Push close to failure on each set with minimal rest between movements.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps
3. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
4. Plank Walk Up; 10 reps (5/side)

C) Strength Intensity 1 (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Farmers Press; 7 reps/side @21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec
2. Lean In DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Cross Body Hammer Curl; 12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, September 18th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Single Arm Plank + Suitcase Single Leg Standing Calf Raise
Two movements that build stability and lower leg strength to finish the session. The single arm plank removes one point of contact, which demands that the core and shoulder resist lateral rotation. The suitcase single leg calf raise adds a unilateral demand to the calf and requires ankle stability through the full range. Keep the rep tempo slow on the calf raise. Three seconds down keeps the calf under tension through the lowering phase.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Suitcase Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Split Stance DB Cross Body RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Arm Plank; 15-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
2. Suitcase Single Leg Standing Calf Raise; 8-10 reps/side @31X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown:
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side

2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, September 19th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 20sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
1. Passive Hang x 1 min

2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
3. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
4. Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
5. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
6. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Recovery Myth: Rest days set you back

This one might be my favorite myth to bust because I used to believe it myself. Early in my training, I thought every day off was a day I lost ground. What I didn't understand yet was that the adaptation, the actual strength and muscle building, happens during recovery, not during the workout itself. Training breaks your body down. Rest is when it rebuilds stronger. Skipping recovery to chase more work usually just leads to burnout, nagging injuries, and performance that stalls out or declines. Your rest days aren't time off from progress. They're part of the process. Trust them.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, September 14th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Shrug + Single Arm Farmers Walk
Shrugs lift your shoulders straight up to work the traps. Squeeze hard at the top before you lower. The farmers walk that follows makes those same muscles hold the weight steady while you walk, so keep the shoulders back and stay tall throughout. You will feel the traps working after this superset.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets

1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
2. Worlds Greatest Stretch; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
2. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
3. Supinated Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. DB Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Single Arm Farmers Walk; 50ft/side

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday, September 15th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Ankles and Wrists

Ankle Circles x 5 each direction

Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side

Heel Sit x 1 min

Toe Sit x 1 min

Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec

Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold

Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 each direction

Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Dumbbell Cross Body Hammer Curl + Dumbbell Skullcrusher

Two arm isolation movements paired to finish the session with a bicep and tricep pump. The cross body hammer curl pulls the dumbbell across the body, emphasizing the brachialis and brachioradialis alongside the biceps. The dumbbell skullcrusher loads the tricep at the stretched

position overhead. Push close to failure on each set with minimal rest between the two movements.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Dumbbell Front Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec
2. DB Bent Over Meadows Row; 10-12 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets

1. Dumbbell Cross Body Hammer Curl; 12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo

rest 45 sec

2. Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 12 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 45 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday, September 17th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Shoulder Flexion

1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10/side with 5 sec hold
3. PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
4. Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 with 3 sec hold
5. Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10
7. Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5

Friday, September 18th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Hanging Knee Tuck

50 total reps of the hanging knee tuck in as few sets as possible. The hanging position demands grip and shoulder stability while the core is being worked. Break the reps up however you need, but keep the rest short between sets. The goal is to accumulate all 50 with quality. Flex the hips fully

on each rep and lower the legs with control rather than dropping them. If the hanging knee tuck is too much, scale to the tuck up on the floor.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
2. DB Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Seated Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Poliquin Step; 10-15 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Elevated Side Plank Hip Taps; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Knee Tuck or Tuck Up; Perform 50 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select the exercise variation that is going to challenge you, but feels attainable.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, September 19th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 20sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row or Bike

2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
3. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
4. Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
5. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
6. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Recovery Myth: Rest days set you back

This one might be my favorite myth to bust because I used to believe it myself. Early in my training, I thought every day off was a day I lost ground. What I didn't understand yet was that the adaptation, the actual strength and muscle building, happens during recovery, not during the workout itself. Training breaks your body down. Rest is when it rebuilds stronger. Skipping recovery to chase more work usually just leads to burnout, nagging injuries, and performance that stalls out or declines. Your rest days aren't time off from progress. They're part of the process. Trust them.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, September 14th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Deficit Deadlift

The deficit deadlift has you stand on a plate so the bar starts lower than normal. That extra range makes your hamstrings and glutes work harder out of the bottom. Keep your chest up and your back flat as you break the bar off the floor, since the longer pull rewards good position. Reps are low this week, so the weight should feel heavy.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
2. DB Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Hinge, Back, Bicep (15 min):
3 Sets
12 Crush Grip Dumbbell Curls
rest 15sec
10 Dual Dumbbell Sumo DL High Pull
rest 15sec
8 Dumbbell Burpees

rest 45-60sec between sets
*Begin with a light weight of around 20-30lb and increase with each set if you are feeling good.
Effort Note: Short rests are intentionally included to allow for high quality on each movement. This is an extension of the Strength Balance section with a higher heart rate.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, September 15th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press
The low incline dumbbell bench sits just above flat, which keeps most of the work on your mid chest while also hitting the upper chest. Dumbbells let each arm move on its own path, which is easier on the shoulders than a barbell. Lower under control and press the dumbbells together at the top. The last set is max unbroken reps, so save some gas for it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
1min Ring or Bar Dip Support
15 DB Lateral Raise 25/15# (Male/Female)
15 Diamond Push Up
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworms
Effort Note:
Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section, the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat comes in at higher reps this block to build your legs and your work capacity. Brace hard before every rep by taking a big breath, squeezing your midsection, then breaking at the hips and knees together. Most missed reps in a high rep set come when bracing slips, not when the legs give out. Keep your depth and speed the same from the first rep to the last.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
2. Worlds Greatest Stretch; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Elevated Side Plank Hip Taps; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
30 Hollow Rocks
30 Switch Lunge (15/side)
30/24 Calorie Row (male/female)
rest 30sec
24 Hollow Rocks
24 Switch Lunge (12/side)
24/18 Calorie Row
rest 30sec
18 Hollow Rocks
18 Switch Lunge (9/side)
18/14 Calorie Row

rest 30sec
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Switch Lunge (6/side)
12/9 Calorie Row
*15min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note:
This workout is broken down into small, digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, September 17th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 5
4 Sets
- Side Plank Rotations x 10/side
- 30sec Extended Wall Plank
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 5
4 Sets
- 30sec Reverse Plank Bridge
- 15sec Clamshell Plank R
- 15sec Clamshell Plank L
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90sec Moderate
Walk 30sec
x 5

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulders
Shoulder Circles x 5/side

Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Friday, September 18th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip
The strict bar dip is back in a straight sets format this week. Keep your elbows tracking back, not flaring wide, to protect your shoulders. The 31X1 tempo means three seconds down, a one second pause at the bottom, then drive up, and that pause kills any bounce to make each rep honest. Finish with a max unbroken set at your first working set weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps
3. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
4. Plank Walk Up; 10 reps (5/side)

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets

1. Farmers Press; 7 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean In DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
Row 125/100m (Male/Female)
8-12 Ring Push Up or Dumbbell Deficit Push Up
Row 125/100m
8 Right Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20#
8 Left Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20#
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest to a minimum throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, September 19th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Walking Lunge
Hold a dumbbell in each hand at your sides, like you're carrying two suitcases, and lunge forward. Keeping the load down at your sides instead of racked on your shoulders lets you handle more weight while your grip and upper back work to keep you tall. Take a controlled step, drop the back knee, and drive through the front heel. Brace your core and keep your chest up so the weight doesn't pull you into a slouch.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets

1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Suitcase Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
100m Run
8/side Split Stance Single Arm Russian KBS
20 Alternating Lunge Box Jump (4-6" Box Height)
100m Run
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the run each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

Recovery Myth: Rest days set you back

This one might be my favorite myth to bust because I used to believe it myself. Early in my training, I thought every day off was a day I lost ground. What I didn't understand yet was that the adaptation, the actual strength and muscle building, happens during recovery, not during the workout itself. Training breaks your body down. Rest is when it rebuilds stronger. Skipping recovery to chase more work usually just leads to burnout, nagging injuries, and performance that stalls out or declines. Your rest days aren't time off from progress. They're part of the process. Trust them.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, September 14th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press
The low incline dumbbell bench sits just above flat, which keeps most of the work on your mid chest while also hitting the upper chest. Dumbbells let each arm move on its own path, which is easier on the shoulders than a barbell. Lower under control and press the dumbbells together at the top. The last set is max unbroken reps, so save some gas for it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
1min Ring or Bar Dip Support
15 DB Hammer Curl 35/25# (Male/Female)
15 Diamond Push Up
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworms
Effort Note:
Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Tuesday, September 15th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat comes in at higher reps this block to build your legs and your work capacity. Brace hard before every rep by taking a big breath, squeezing your midsection, then breaking at the hips and knees together. Most missed reps in a high rep set come when bracing slips, not when the legs give out. Keep your depth and speed the same from the first rep to the last.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
2. Worlds Greatest Stretch; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Elevated Side Plank Hip Taps; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
30 Hollow Rocks
30 Switch Lunge (15/side)
30/24 Calorie Row (Male/Female)

rest 30 sec
24 Hollow Rocks
24 Switch Lunge (12/side)
24/18 Calorie Row
rest 30 sec
18 Hollow Rocks
18 Switch Lunge (9/side)
18/14 Calorie Row
rest 30 sec
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Switch Lunge (6/side)
12/9 Calorie Row
*15 min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note:
This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulders
Shoulder Circles x 5/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side

Passive Hang x 1 min

Thursday, September 17th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Strict Bar Dip
The strict bar dip is back in a straight sets format this week. Keep your elbows tracking back, not flaring wide, to protect your shoulders. The 31X1 tempo means three seconds down, a one second pause at the bottom, then drive up, and that pause kills any bounce to make each rep honest. Finish with a max unbroken set at your first working set weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps
3. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
4. Plank Walk Up; 10 reps (5/side)

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:

This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
Row 125/100m (Male/Female)
8-12 Ring Push Up or Dumbbell Deficit Push Up
Row 125/100m
8 Right Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20#
8 Left Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20#
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, September 18th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Deficit Deadlift
The deficit deadlift has you stand on a plate so you start from a slightly lower position, which makes your hamstrings and glutes work harder off the floor and builds strength right where the pull is hardest. Keep the bar close to your body and drive your hips and shoulders up together. Reps drop from the last deficit week, so aim to add weight while you hold your positions.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
100m Run
8/side Split Stance Single Arm Russian KB Swings
20 Alternating Lunge Box Jump (4-6" Box Height)
100m Run
rest 90 sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the run each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, September 19th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 20sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension

1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
3. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
4. Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
5. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
6. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

Recovery Myth: Rest days set you back

This one might be my favorite myth to bust because I used to believe it myself. Early in my training, I thought every day off was a day I lost ground. What I didn't understand yet was that the adaptation, the actual strength and muscle building, happens during recovery, not during the workout itself. Training breaks your body down. Rest is when it rebuilds stronger. Skipping recovery to chase more work usually just leads to burnout, nagging injuries, and performance that stalls out or declines. Your rest days aren't time off from progress. They're part of the process. Trust them.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, September 14th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat comes in at higher reps this block to build your legs and your work capacity. Brace hard before every rep by taking a big breath, squeezing your midsection, then breaking at the hips and knees together. Most missed reps in a high rep set come when bracing slips, not when the legs give out. Keep your depth and speed the same from the first rep to the last.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
2. Worlds Greatest Stretch; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
Row 125/100m (Male/Female)
8-12 Ring Push Up or Dumbbell Deficit Push Up
Row 125/100m
8 Right Arm Dumbbell Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20#
8 Left Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20#
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday, September 15th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 each direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 each direction

Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press
The low incline dumbbell bench sits just above flat, which keeps most of the work on your mid chest while also hitting the upper chest. Dumbbells let each arm move on its own path, which is easier on the shoulders than a barbell. Lower under control and press the dumbbells together at the top. The last set is max unbroken reps, so save some gas for it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Dumbbell External Rotation on Knee; 10 reps/side
3. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Elevated Side Plank Hip Taps; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge, Back, Bicep (15 min):
3 Sets
12 Crush Grip Dumbbell Curls
rest 15sec
10 Dual Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift High Pull
rest 15sec
8 Dumbbell Burpees
rest 45-60sec between sets
*Begin with a light weight of around 20-30lb and increase with each set if you are feeling good.
Effort Note:
Short rests are intentionally included to allow for high quality on each movement. This is an extension of the Strength Balance section with a higher heart rate.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday, September 17th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Shoulder Flexion
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10/side with 5 sec hold
3. PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
4. Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 with 3 sec hold
5. Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10
7. Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5

Friday, September 18th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Deficit Deadlift
The deficit deadlift has you stand on a plate so you start from a slightly lower position, which makes your hamstrings and glutes work harder off the floor and builds strength right where the pull is hardest. Keep the bar close to your body and drive your hips and shoulders up together. Reps drop from the last deficit week, so aim to add weight while you hold your positions.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
2. Dumbbell Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo

- rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
100m Run
8/side Split Stance Single Arm Russian KB Swings
20 Alternating Lunge Box Jump (4-6" Box Height)
100m Run
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the run each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, September 19th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%

2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 20sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
3. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
4. Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
5. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
6. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

Recovery Myth: Rest days set you back

This one might be my favorite myth to bust because I used to believe it myself. Early in my training, I thought every day off was a day I lost ground. What I didn't understand yet was that the adaptation, the actual strength and muscle building, happens during recovery, not during the workout itself. Training breaks your body down. Rest is when it rebuilds stronger. Skipping recovery

to chase more work usually just leads to burnout, nagging injuries, and performance that stalls out or declines. Your rest days aren't time off from progress. They're part of the process. Trust them.

Warmly, Marcus

Perform

Monday, September 14th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Deficit Deadlift
The deficit deadlift alternates with the sumo across this cycle. Standing on a plate lengthens the range of motion and forces the hamstrings and glutes to work harder off the floor. Keep the bar close and drive the hips and shoulders up together out of the bottom. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, so the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Run Mix Modal based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Supine Band Lat Pullover; 10-15 reps
1. DB Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Full Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy

Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Deficit Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. Ring Row or Body Row; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo (aim for 6-15 reps)
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note: This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pull down using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

F) Run Mix Modal (12 min):
12 min SUSTAINED PACE
4 Shuttle Run
6 GHD Sit Ups
8 Alternating DB Snatch 50/35# (Male/Female)
Effort Note: To maximize the total reps during the 12 minutes, perform at a sustainable pace. Start smooth; at about 4 minutes start to pick up the pace if you are feeling great.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, September 15th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Low Incline DB Bench Press
The low incline dumbbell bench alternates with the flat bench across this cycle. The slight incline shifts more of the work onto the upper chest, while the dumbbells let each arm move on its own path, which is easier on the shoulders. Lower under control and press the dumbbells together at the top, saving enough for the max unbroken final set. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, so the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Upper Intervals based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Dumbbell External Rotation on Knee; 10 reps/side
1. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) HS HOT START (15 min):
Every 3 min x 5 Sets
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Up
6 Burpee Box Jumps
Row 18/15 Cals

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

F) Upper Intervals (12 min):
3 sets
AMRAP 1 min - Double Unders or Single Unders
AMRAP 1 min - Dual KB Clean from Floor 53/35# (Male/Female)
AMRAP 1 min - Bike for Max Calories
rest 1 min between sets
Effort Note: The goal here is to challenge local muscle endurance. Take short breaks before you hit failure so that you can maximize the number of reps within the minute. Try to not take more than 10 seconds break during any minute.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
1. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
1. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat alternates with the 1 1/4 cyclist version across this cycle. Without the heel elevation, the demand shifts toward the posterior chain and asks for more hip and ankle mobility to hold depth. This is a volume block, so the reps build from Week 2 rather than drop, adding total work each time it returns. Keep the depth and speed honest from the first rep to the last.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Lower Sprint based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
1. Worlds Greatest Stretch; 6-8 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press

10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
Every 2:00-3:00 x 5 sets
1 Power Clean + 3 Broad Jumps
rest until next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Elevated Side Plank Hip Taps; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warm up sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Lower Sprint (10 min):
Every 2:30 x 5 sets
16 GHD Sit Ups or Bodyweight Sit Ups
16 Jumping Lunge on Box
20 sec Row SPRINT
rest until the start of the next 2:30
Effort Note: Use the following guide to approach each set with escalating effort on the Row.
Set 1 - Moderate Effort - RPE 7-8
Set 2 - Hard Effort - RPE 8-9
Sets 3-5 - Maximal Effort - RPE 9-10

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
1. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, September 17th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90 sec Moderate
Walk 30 sec
x 5
4 Sets:
- Side Plank Rotations x 10/side
- 30 sec Extended Wall Plank
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90 sec Moderate
Walk 30 sec
x 5
4 Sets:
- 30 sec Reverse Plank Bridge
- 15 sec Clamshell Plank R
- 15 sec Clamshell Plank L
Run, Bike, Ski, or Row 90 sec Moderate
Walk 30 sec
x 5

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-12 min):
Shoulders
Shoulder Circles x 5/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or Shoulder Wall Circles) x 5/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Friday, September 18th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip
Back to the heavy straight set dip from Week 1. The 31X1 tempo keeps the tension high through a controlled descent and a strong drive out of the bottom. Aim to add load or reduce assistance compared to the first week while holding the same clean depth. The last set is again max unbroken reps at your Set 1 weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Push Pull based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps
1. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
1. Plank Walk Up; 10 reps (5/side)

C) KB HOT START (10 min):
3-4 sets
15/12 Cal Row
2 Single Arm Russian Swing L
3 Single Arm KB Snatch L
4 Single Arm KB Split Snatch L
2 Single Arm Russian Swing R
3 Single Arm KB Snatch R
4 Single Arm KB Split Snatch R
rest 30 sec between sets

D) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Farmers Press; 7 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean In DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12 min Continuous Clock
Row 125/100m (Male/Female)
8/side Alternating DB Push Press 50/35#
Row 125/100m
10-15 Chest to Bar Kipping Pull Ups
Effort Note: Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, September 19th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Walking Lunge
The suitcase walking lunge alternates with the front rack split squat across this cycle. A heavy dumbbell in each hand loads the legs while adding a grip and core demand through the walk. Take controlled steps and keep the torso tall, using straps if grip fails before the legs do. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, so the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Power 30 based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps

1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Suitcase Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Power 30 (30 min):
Part 1 — For Time @ Tough Effort (7 min Cap)
10 Burpee
20 Cal Row
15 Single Arm DB Power Snatch Right Arm 50/35# (Male/Female)
15 Single Arm DB Power Snatch Left Arm 50/35#
20 Cal Row
10 Burpee
Effort Note: These Time Caps are intentionally challenging. Work hard to try and get your time under this number, but by no means get down if you don't. You will get a minimum of 3 minutes rest before part 2 regardless. The DB weight should allow you to perform both sets unbroken; adjust accordingly.
Part 2 — Beginning at 10 min on the clock, Every 5 min x 4 Sets:
8-15 Calorie Row
12-20 Wall Balls (20/14, 10'/9')
8-12 DB Suitcase Box Step Up (50/35#) (16"/12")
8-15 Calorie Row
*rest the remainder of the time before the next 5 min period
Effort Note: This movement combination is very tough. Start conservative on your reps and add more as you go. The DB weight should allow you to perform the first set unbroken with the expectation of breaking up a little more each round; adjust accordingly.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
1. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

Recovery Myth: Rest days set you back

This one might be my favorite myth to bust because I used to believe it myself. Early in my training, I thought every day off was a day I lost ground. What I didn't understand yet was that the adaptation, the actual strength and muscle building, happens during recovery, not during the workout itself. Training breaks your body down. Rest is when it rebuilds stronger. Skipping recovery to chase more work usually just leads to burnout, nagging injuries, and performance that stalls out or declines. Your rest days aren't time off from progress. They're part of the process. Trust them.

Warmly, Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, September 14th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Low Incline DB Bench Press
The low incline dumbbell bench sits just above flat, which keeps most of the work on your mid chest while also hitting the upper chest. Dumbbells let each arm move on its own path, which is easier on the shoulders. Lower under control and press the dumbbells together at the top. The last set is max unbroken reps, so save some gas for it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. DB ER on Knee; 10 reps/side
1. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Filly Press; 7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 10-30 sec
2. Deficit Wide Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 10 sec
3. Narrow Push Up; 5-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. If unable to complete 5 quality deficit push ups, perform with no deficit.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
1min Ring or Bar Dip Support
15 DB Hammer Curl 35/25# (Male/Female)
15 Diamond Push Up
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworms
Effort Note: Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
1. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
1. Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Tuesday, September 15th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Goblet Squat
The goblet squat comes in at higher reps this block to build your legs and your work capacity. Brace hard before every rep by taking a big breath, squeezing your midsection, then breaking at the hips and knees together. Most missed reps in a high rep set come when bracing slips, not when the legs give out. Keep your depth and speed the same from the first rep to the last.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side
1. Worlds Greatest Stretch; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Goblet Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 18 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 18 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 18 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Elevated Side Plank Hip Taps; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
30 Hollow Rocks
30 Switch Lunge (15/side)
30 Burpee
rest 30sec
24 Hollow Rocks
24 Switch Lunge (12/side)
24 Burpee
rest 30sec
18 Hollow Rocks
18 Switch Lunge (9/side)
18 Burpee
rest 30sec
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Switch Lunge (6/side)
12 Burpee
*15min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note: This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
1. Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, September 16th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulders
Shoulder Circles x5/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min

Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Thursday, September 17th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Strict Pull Up
Your pulling strength runs as a mechanical drop set this cycle, so the back keeps working after your hardest position fatigues. Start with pronated strict pull ups at a 21X1 tempo, using only the assistance you need to hit the reps clean, then move into the DB gorilla row once your overhand grip is spent. Reps on the pull up sit at eight this week, a step heavier than Week 2, so make each pull reach the same height and control the lower on every rep. Stay strict with no kip and keep your shoulder blades pulling down and back.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Band Pull Apart; 15 reps
1. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
1. Plank Walk Up; 10 reps (5/side)

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 15 sec
2. DB Gorilla Row; 20 reps (R+L=2) @30X0 Tempo
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note: This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets

1. Farmers Press; 7 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Lean In DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
Run 100m
8-12 Ring Push Up or Dumbbell Deficit Push Up
Run 100m
8 Right Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20# (Male/Female)
8 Left Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20#
Effort Note: Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, September 18th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Split Stance DB RDL
The split stance dumbbell RDL sets one foot slightly back so the front leg carries most of the load, which lets you train each hamstring and glute on its own. Hold the dumbbells close to your legs, push the front hip straight back, and feel the stretch down the back of that front thigh before you stand tall. Keep a soft front knee and a flat back, and only lower as far as your hamstrings allow. Reps climb by one per side from Week 2, so hold a strong load while you add the extra volume. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps

1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance DB RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
100m Run
20 Alternating Lunge Box Jump (4-6" Box Height)
30 Mountain Climbers (15/side)
100m Run
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note: Aim to increase the pace on the run each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown:
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
1. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, September 19th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 20sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 20sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row or Bike
2min @ 70%
1:30 @ 80%
1min @ 90%
1:30 @ 80%
2min @ 70%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
1. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
1. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10
1. Prone I Raise x 5 with 5 sec hold
1. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
1. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10

Sunday, September 20th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

Recovery Myth: Rest days set you back

This one might be my favorite myth to bust because I used to believe it myself. Early in my training, I thought every day off was a day I lost ground. What I didn't understand yet was that the adaptation, the actual strength and muscle building, happens during recovery, not during the workout itself. Training breaks your body down. Rest is when it rebuilds stronger. Skipping recovery to chase more work usually just leads to burnout, nagging injuries, and performance that stalls out or declines. Your rest days aren't time off from progress. They're part of the process. Trust them.

Warmly, Marcus